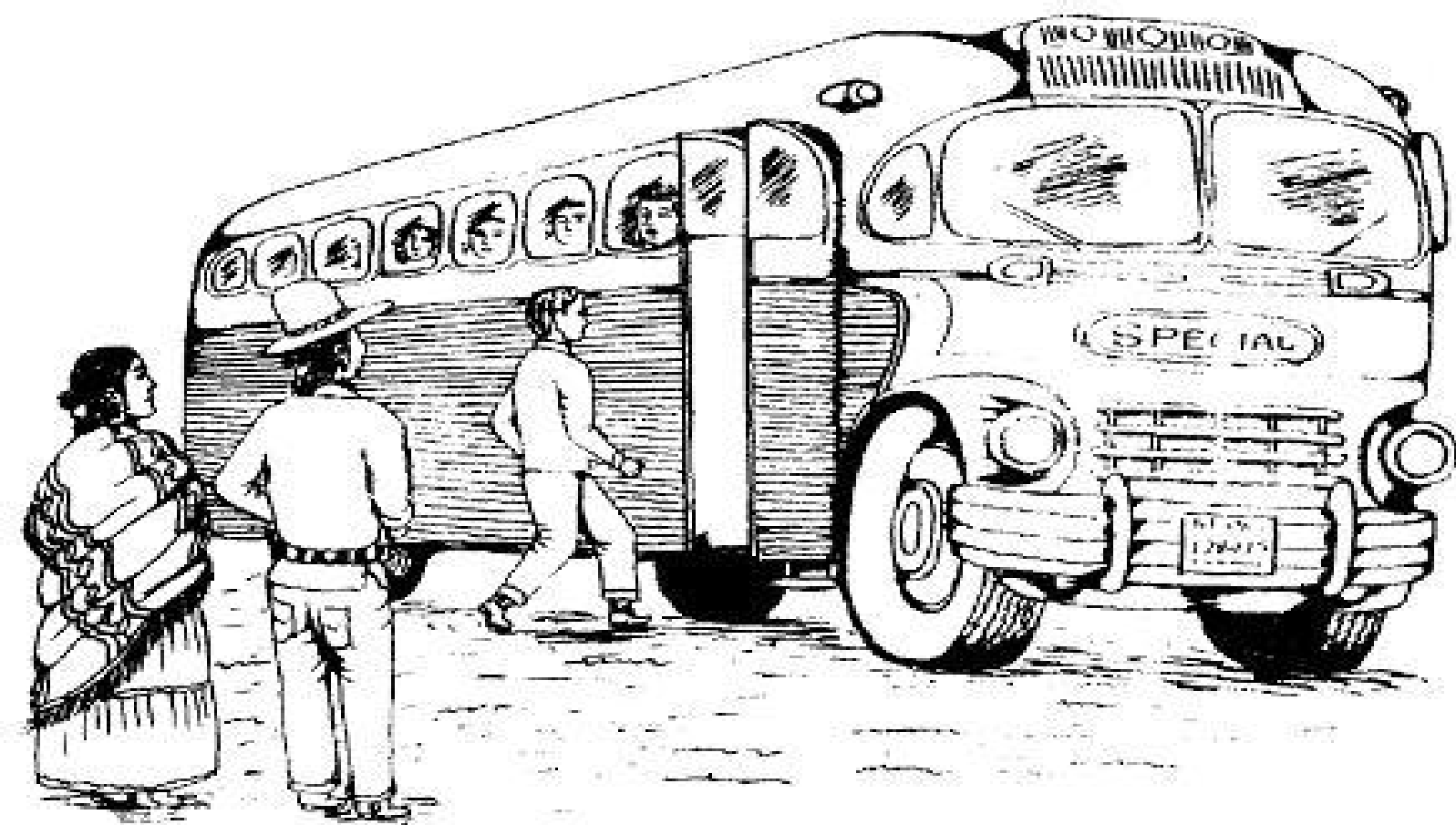


AWAY TO SCHOOL

'ÓLTA'GÓÓ



by CECIL S. KING

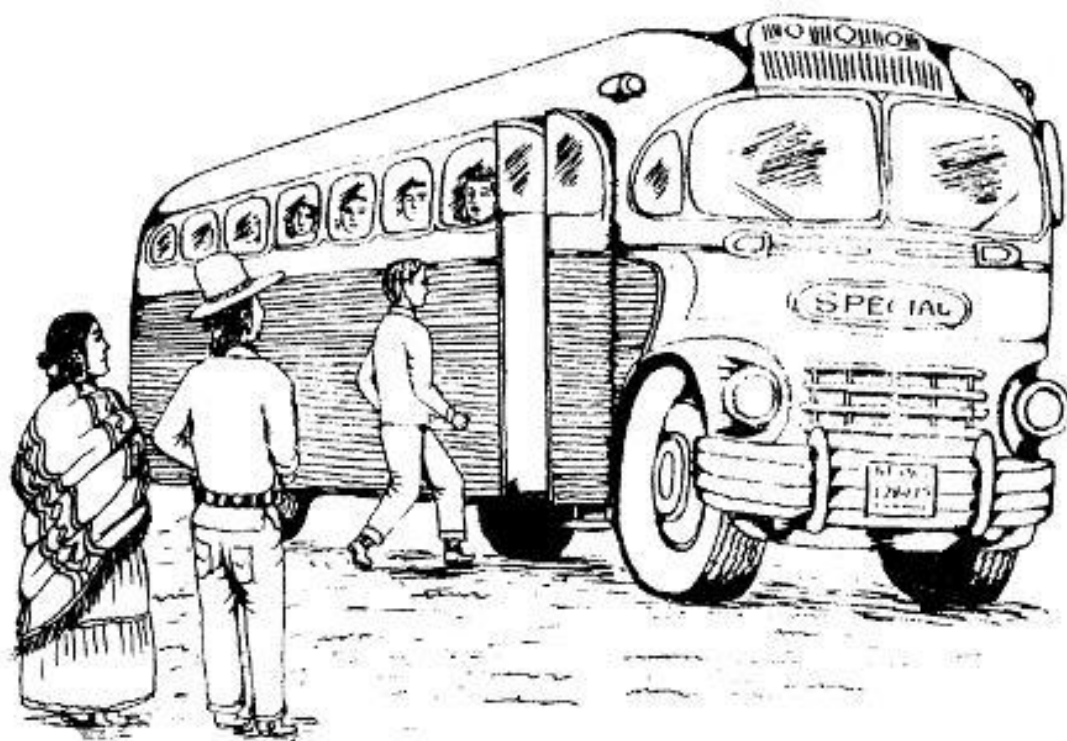
Navajo Text by
RAMONA M. SMITH

Illustrated by
FRANKLIN KAHN

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NAVAJO NEW WORLD READERS • 1

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UNITED STATES INDIAN SERVICE

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Translator: Ramona M. Smith

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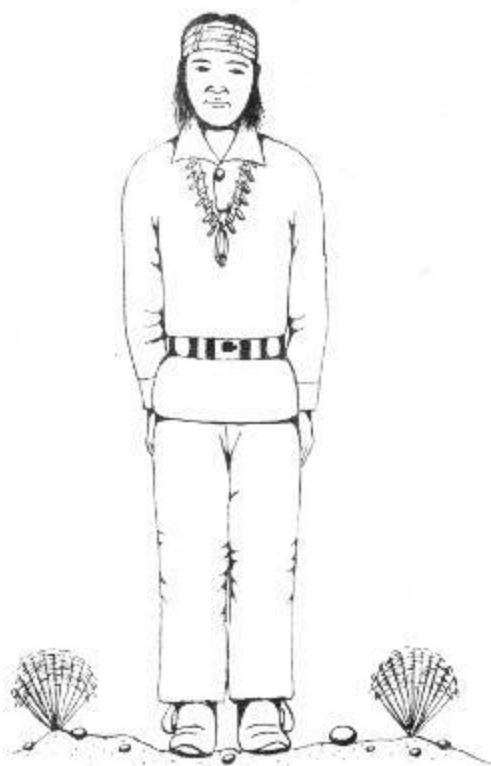
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NAVAJO NEW WORLD READERS

At this writing (1951) there are approximately 26,000 children of school age on the Navajo reservation. About 40 percent of these are between the ages of 12 and 18. The great majority have never been inside a school, and do not speak English. Recently the government has provided space for more than 4,000 of these non-English-speaking adolescents in ten of its off-reservation boarding schools. A five-year intensive educational program is provided designed to teach these children to speak, read, write, and think in English; to do simple arithmetic, to know the facts of American history, world geography, civics and health; and to provide the basic skills which will enable them to obtain and hold a permanent job away from the reservation. The reservation resources will support only about half the present population.

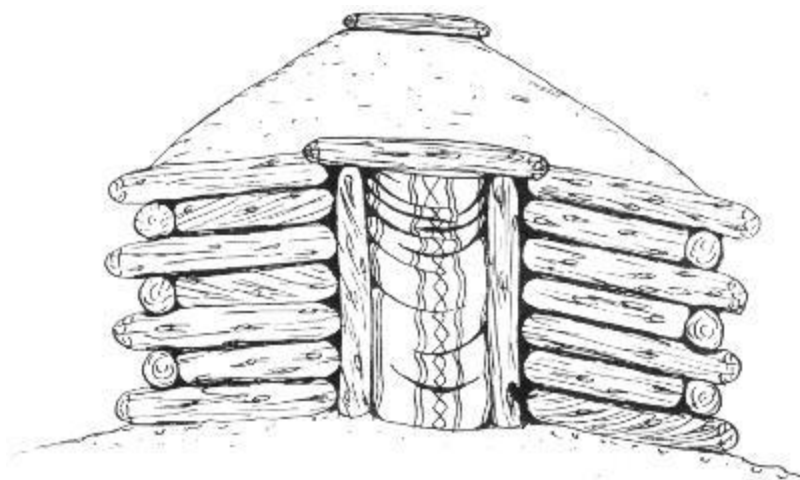
We have learned how to teach these non-English-speaking Navajos to speak and read English very rapidly. However, there isn't much material for them to read. They are maturing adolescents with adolescent interests. Primers and first readers prepared for use by six-year-old public school children don't have much interest for them. Because most non-Indians learn to read when they are young, very few books are published in which the ideas are mature, but the vocabularies simple enough for beginning readers. The Indian Service, therefore, has undertaken the preparation and printing of a series of readers, written by the leaders who are working directly with these children. Because the children are entering a new culture, and their success will depend upon the degree to which they make the basic ideas of this culture their own, these new books will rely on the material of this new culture for their content. They are therefore being grouped under the general title "Navajo New World Readers," for they will present to these young people a new and different world from that through which they have grown during their early years on the reservation.

Willard W. Beatty
Chief, Branch of Education



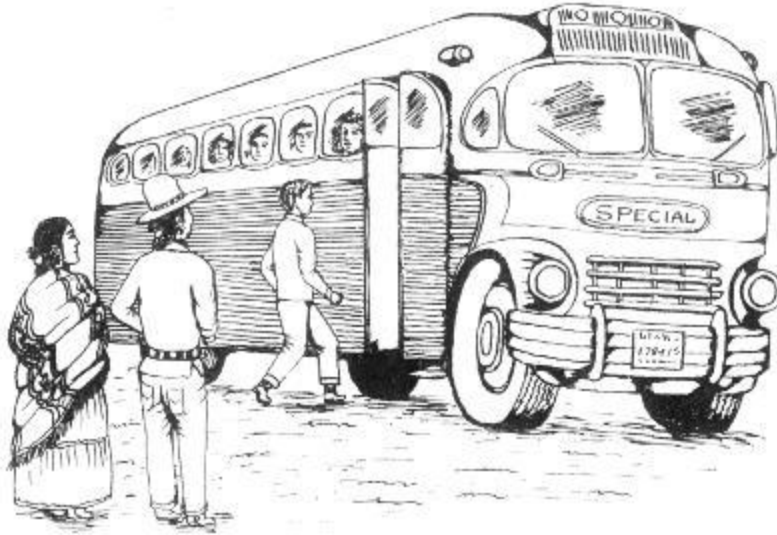
I am a Navajo boy.

Shí Naabeehó 'ashkii nishł́í.



This is my home.

Díidi shí shighan.

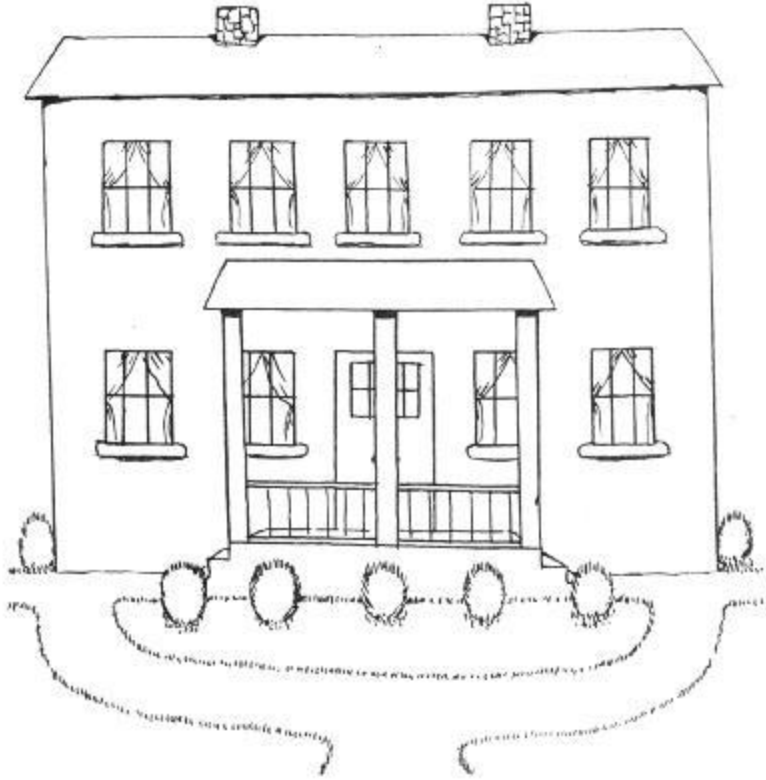


I go to school.

I go to my school on a bus.

Shí 'ííníshṭa'.

Shí 'ólta'góó chidíłgaai bee 'ahnánáshdááh.

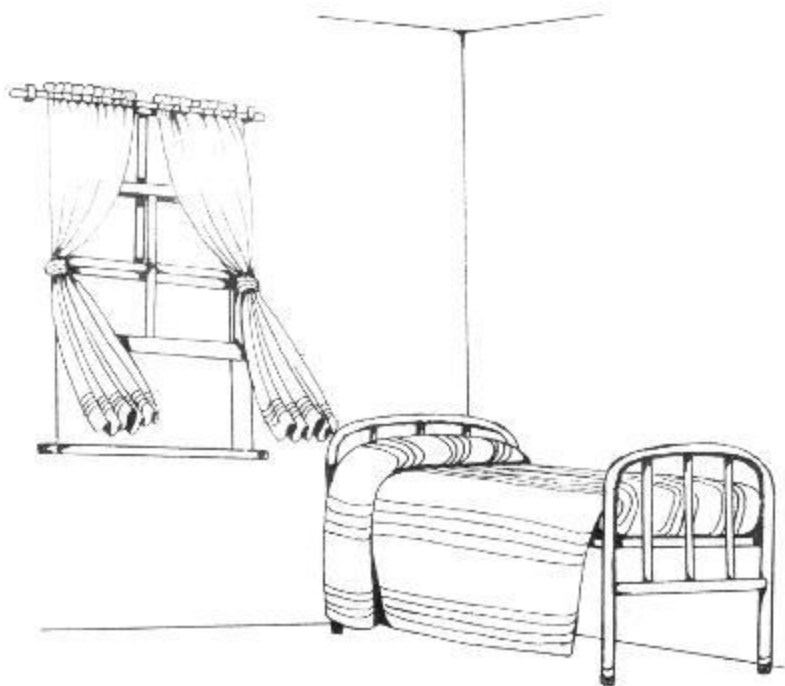


I go to my school in the fall.

My school is far from my home.

Shí 'aak'eego 'ólta'góó 'aḵnánáshdááh.

Shighan dóó doo deighánígóó 'íínishta'.

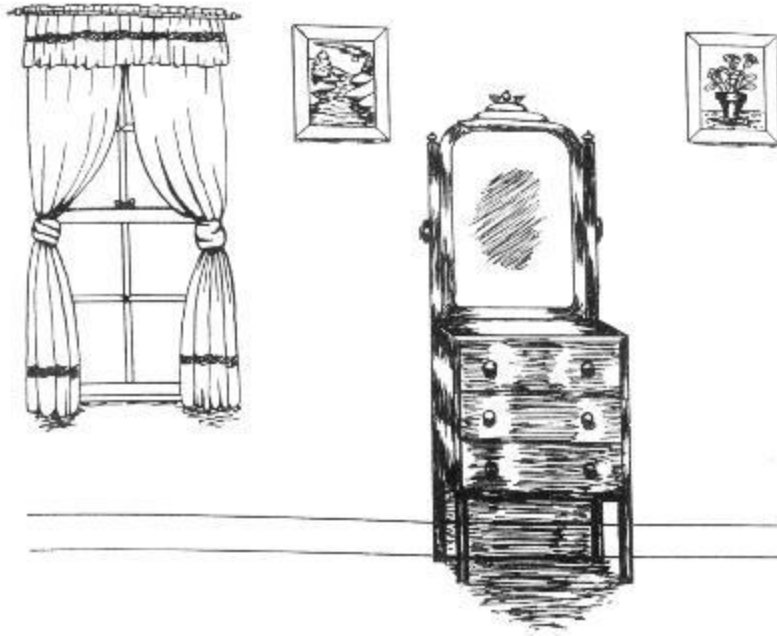


I live at my school.

I open my window when I sleep.

Shi 'ólta'di shighan.

Shi tsésq' dei 'át'éego ná'iishwosh.

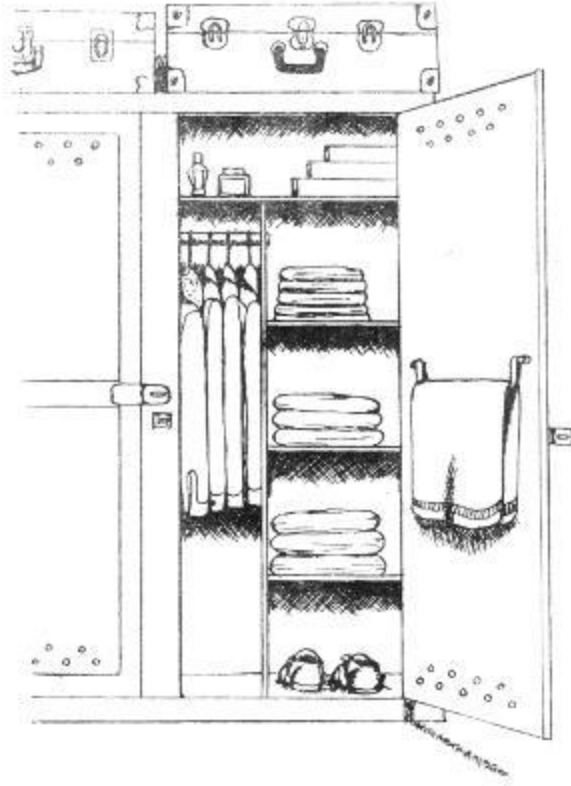


This is my room.

I clean my room.

Kónéé shighan.

Shighan góne' hasht'e hwíínísín.

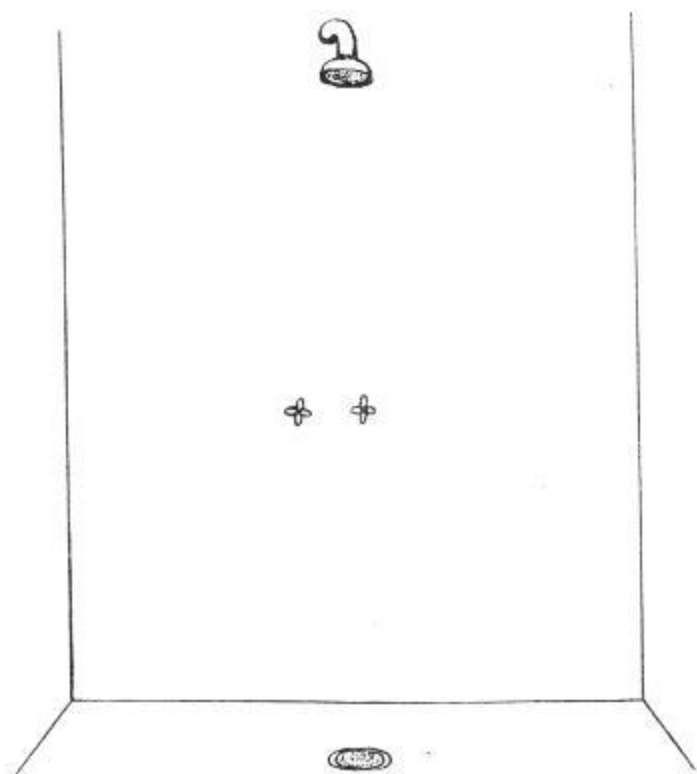


This is my locker.

I put my clean clothes in my locker.

Díidí shi'ée' biyi' sinilí 'át'é.

Shi'ée' chin baqah 'ádaadínígíí kóne' síłnít.



This is the shower.

Díí kwii tó nááljigo biyaa tá'ádazdigis.



I take a bath in the shower.

I am clean.

Tó shik'iji' náálíigo tá'ánídísgis.

Chin shąq̣h 'ádin.

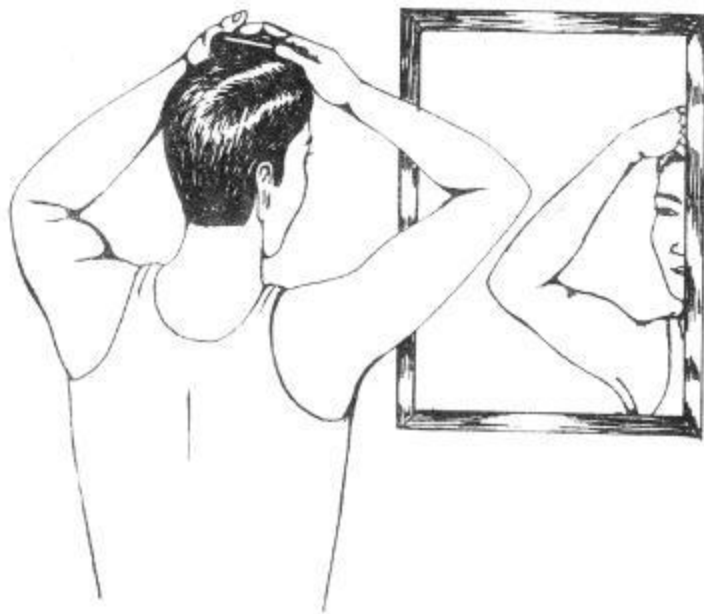


I wash my hair.

My hair is clean.

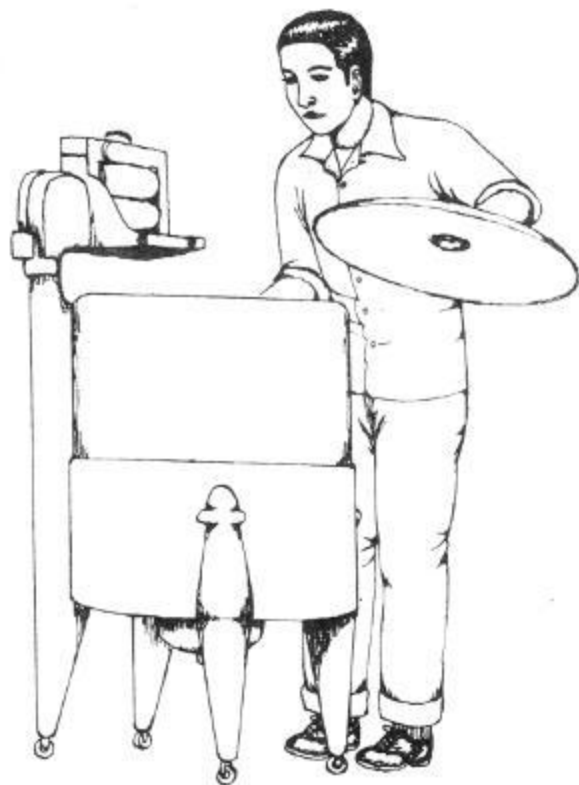
Shitsii' tánínásgis.

Shitsii' chin bąq̣h 'ádin.



I comb my hair.

Shitsii' náshoh.



I wash my clothes.

My clothes are clean.

Shi'ée' nídeisgis.

Shi'ée' chin bəqəh 'ádin.



I can iron.

I iron my clean clothes.

'Éé' nídadiilkqoh bééhasin.

Shi'éé' chin baqah 'ádaadinígíí nínádadiishkqoh.

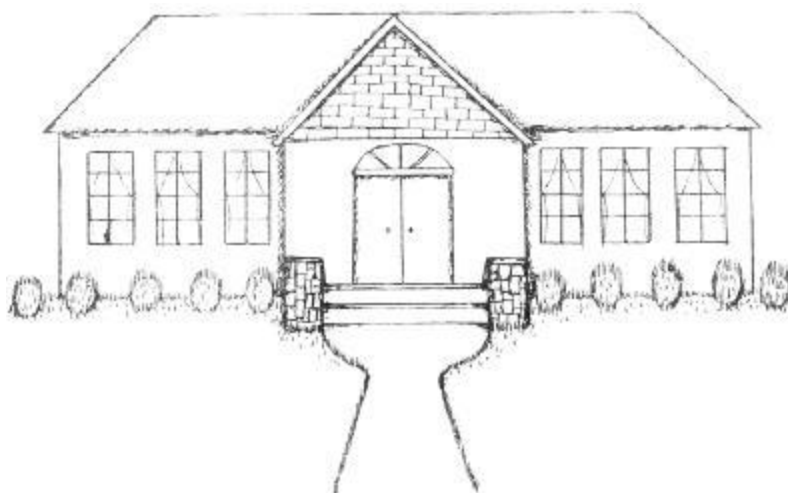


These are my shoes.

I clean my shoes.

Díidí shikee' 'át'é.

Shikee' baa 'áháshyá.



I go to the dining room.

'Áłchíní da'ayánígóó 'ałnánáshdááh.



I eat breakfast.

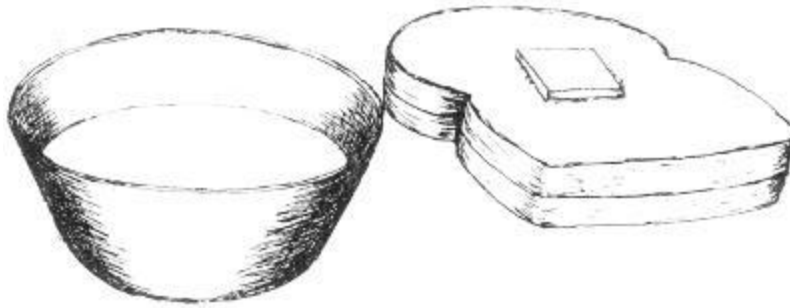
I eat dinner.

I eat supper.

'Ahbínígo ná'áshdǫ́h.

'Ałné'é'áahgo ná'áshdǫ́h.

'E'e'áahgo ná'áshdǫ́h.



I eat bread and butter.

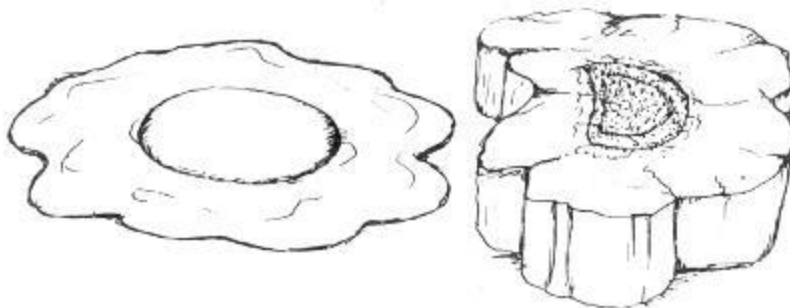
I eat cereal.

I like cereal.

Shí bááh doo mandagíiya náshdííh.

Shí ch'il bílástsii' dahólónígíí náshdííh.

Ch'il bílástsii' dahólónígíí shíł łikan.



I eat eggs.

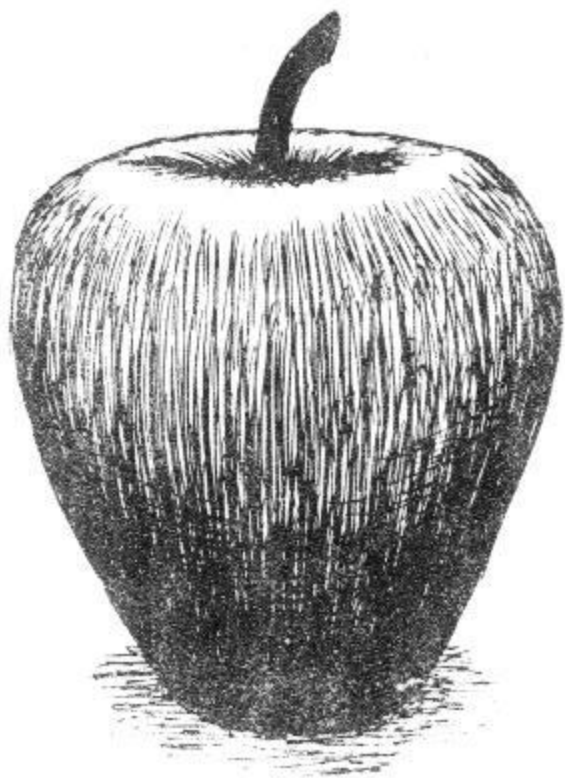
I eat meat.

I like eggs and meat.

Shí 'ayęęzhii náshdííh.

Shí 'atsi' náshdííh.

'Ayęęzhii dóó 'atsi shíł łikan.



Apples are good.

I like apples.

Bilasáana náshdǵǵh.

Bilasáana shił ǵikan.

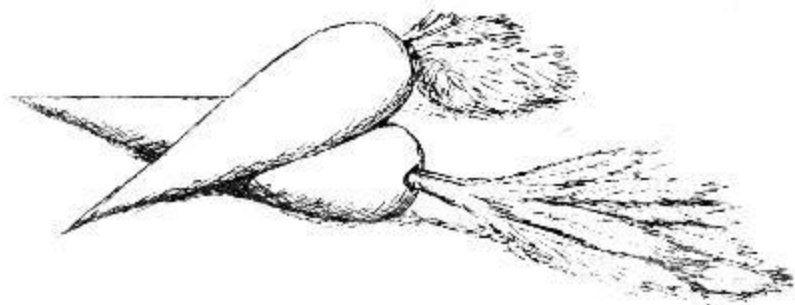


This is fruit.

I like fruit.

Díidí tsin bineest'ą' 'át'é.

Tsin bineest'ą' shił łikan.



These are carrots.

I eat carrots.

Díidí chaqsht'ezhiitsoh 'át'é.
Shí chaqsht'ezhiitsoh náshdǵǵh.



These are vegetables.
I like vegetables.

Díidí ch'il daadánígíí 'át'é.
Shí ch'il daadánígíí shíł łikan.

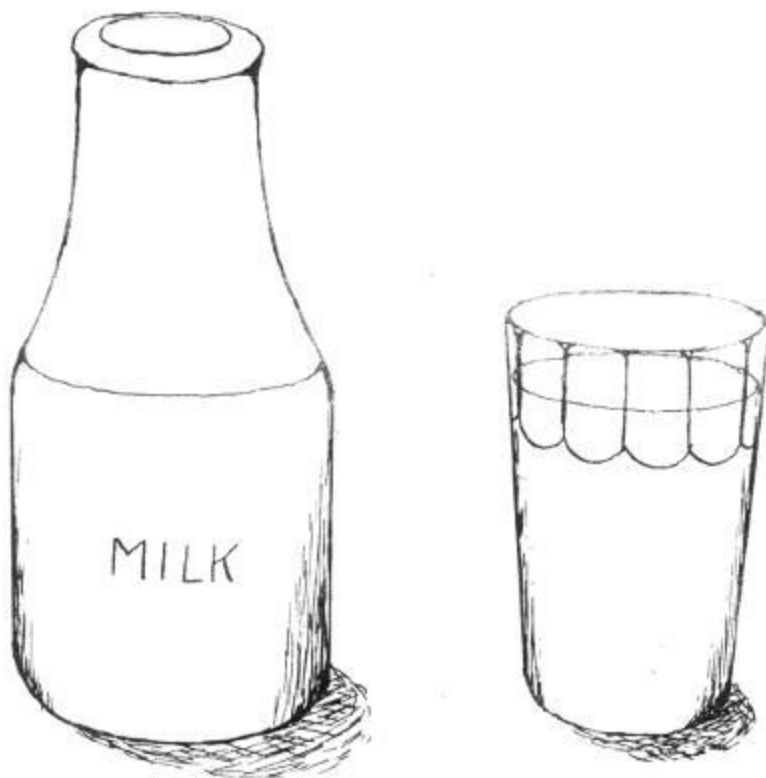


I drink orange juice.

Orange juice is good.

Shí ch'il ɬitsooí bitoo' náshdlííh.

Ch'il ɬitsooí bitoo' shíł ɬikan.



I drink milk every day.

I like milk.

T'áá 'ákwííjǫ 'abe' yishdlá.

'Abe' 'ayóogo shił łikan.



I brush my teeth every day.

My teeth are clean.

T'áá 'ákwííjǐ shiwoo' tánínásgis.

Shiwoo' chin bąqah 'ádin.



I play outdoors.

I am happy.

Shí tǎ'óo'di naashnéé leh.

Shí shíł hózhq.



This is the nurse.

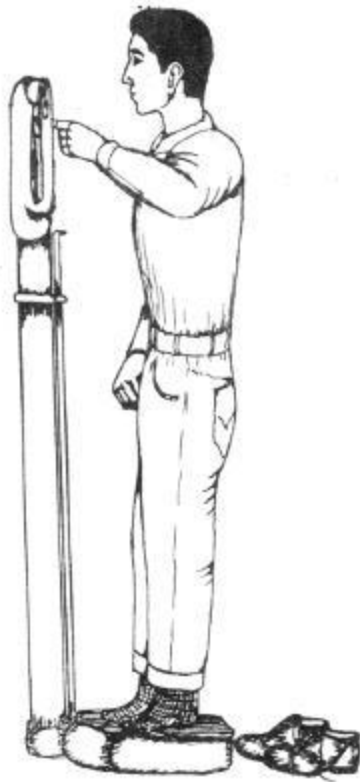
The nurse is my friend.

She helps me keep well.

Díidí 'asdzání ázee' 'íł'íní 'át'é.

Asdzáán 'azee' 'íł'íní sik'is.

Asdzáán 'azee' 'íł'ini shitah yá'áhoot'ée'h áhósín.



I weigh one hundred pounds.

I grow.

Neeznádíín dah hidíníshdlo’.

Neeséél.

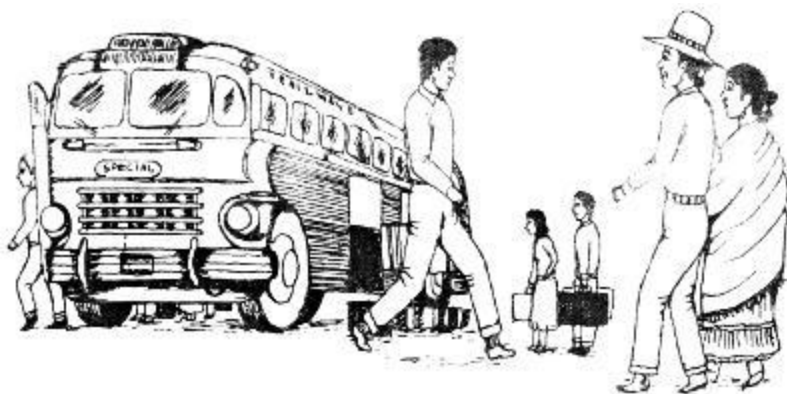


I study my lessons.

I learn many things.

Bilagáanaa bizaad bíhoosh'aah.

T'óó 'ahayóí 'áhtah 'ádaat'éego bíhoosh'aah.



I will go home in the spring.

I will tell my people about my school.

Ch'éenídaango shighangóó níkéédeeshdáál.

Shighandi nánísdzáago shidine'é shi'ólta' bee bił
hashné doo.

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